

# Recitation 13: Pittsburgh Supercomputing Cluster

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Understanding your PSC dashboard

2

Apply for the Explore ACCESS Grant

3

Managing your grant



Carnegie  
Mellon  
University



University of  
Pittsburgh

# Apply for the Explore ACCESS Grant

## Steps

1. Sign up [here](#)

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

Sign up on <https://identity.access-ci.org/new-user>

existing XSEDE/ACCESS account. You can [request a username reminder](#) and/or [reset your password](#) to continue using an existing account. If you're having trouble accessing an existing account, please [contact us](#) rather than creating another one.

### Registration Tips

To avoid problems during registration, please:

1. Do not exit your browser during the registration process. If you exit in the middle of the registration process, you'll need to [contact us](#) for assistance.
2. Be sure to complete the email verification. You will receive an email from [registry@cilogon.org](mailto:registry@cilogon.org) containing a code that you need to enter to complete your registration. If you don't receive the email in your inbox, please check your spam folder. If you fail to complete the email verification, you'll need to [contact us](#) for assistance.

### Two Options for New User Registration

If you don't already have an XSEDE or ACCESS account, there are two registration options:

1. **Register with an existing identity:** Using an existing University account when registering with ACCESS simplifies the sign-up process and enables you to log in to ACCESS using that existing account. With this option, creating an ACCESS-specific password is optional during registration, and you will also have the option to create an ACCESS-specific password later if needed.

If your University is not included in the listing or you have trouble logging in with your University account, please use the other registration option.

2. **Register without an existing identity:** With this option, you'll be prompted to enter all your registration info and select an ACCESS-specific password and set up [Duo MFA for ACCESS](#). You can [link](#) a GitHub, Google, Microsoft, ORCID, or University account later if desired.

When configuring Duo MFA, we recommend that you [install the Duo security app](#) on your phone and configure it to use Duo Mobile / [Duo Push](#). We do not recommend the [Phone Call](#) option, because it is unreliable.

Focus Areas

Infrastructure

FAQs

Help

Cybersecurity

Existing Infrastructure

Networking & Data

New Infrastructure

What is PSC? What are its Grants?

Applying for the 'Explore' grant

Managing your grant

# Apply for the Explore ACCESS Grant

## Steps

The TA assigned to your project can provide you with the advisor letter

1. Sign up [here](#)
2. Ask TA for advisor letter
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.
- 7.



What is PSC? What are its Grants?

**Applying for the 'Explore' grant**

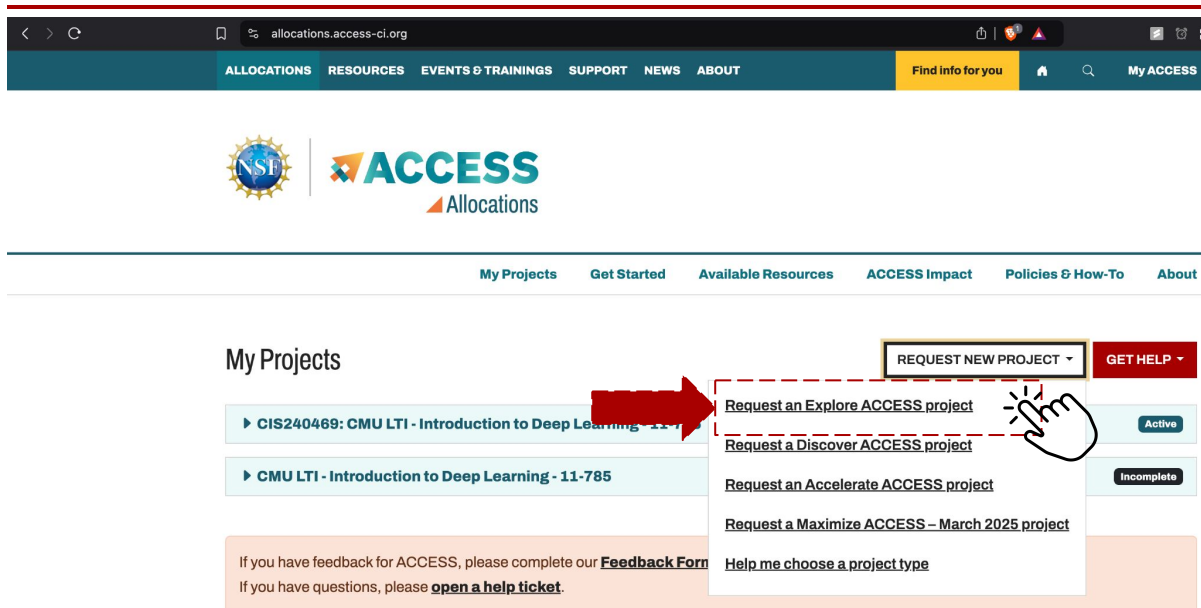
Managing your grant

# Apply for the Explore ACCESS Grant

## Steps

1. Sign up [here](#)
2. Ask TA for advisor letter
3. Request an **Explore** ACCESS Project
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.

On the [dashboard](#), Request an Explore ACCESS Project



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## Project Types

There are four different project types to choose from: Explore, Discover, Accelerate, and Maximize. And if you're not sure, you can always start with an Explore project and upgrade as you learn more about your resource needs. Even if you know you'll eventually need a Maximize project, you can begin with a smaller project so you can get started while you wait for the next semi-annual round of Maximize proposals to be reviewed. The table below compares the key features of each of the different project types.

- **EXPLORE** — Great for resource evaluation, graduate student projects, small classes and training events, benchmarking, code development and porting, and similar small-scale uses.
- **DISCOVER** — Designed for research grants with modest resource needs, Campus Champions, large classes and training events, graduate student projects, benchmarking and code testing at scale, and gateway development.
- **ACCELERATE** — Best for experienced users with mid-scale resource needs, consolidating multi-grant programs, collaborative projects, preparing for Maximize ACCESS requests, and gateways with growing communities.
- **MAXIMIZE** — The choice for large-scale research activities that need more resources than the limit for Accelerate ACCESS projects.

Comparison Table

| Project Type                    | Explore                                                             | Discover                                                            | Accelerate                                                          | Maximize                       |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| ACCESS Credits*                 | 400,000                                                             | 1,500,000                                                           | 3,000,000                                                           | Awarded in resource units      |
| Project duration                | Supporting grant duration or 12 months, whichever period is greater | Supporting grant duration or 12 months, whichever period is greater | Supporting grant duration or 12 months, whichever period is greater | 12 months                      |
| Requests accepted               | Anytime                                                             | Anytime                                                             | Anytime                                                             | Every 6 months                 |
|                                 | Multiple requests allowed                                           | Multiple requests allowed                                           | Multiple requests allowed                                           | 1 allowed (some exceptions)    |
| Requirements and review process | Overview                                                            | 1-page proposal                                                     | 3-page proposal (max. length)                                       | 10-page proposal (max. length) |
|                                 | Confirmation of eligibility and suitability of requested resources  | Confirmation of eligibility and suitability of requested resources  | Panel merit review                                                  | Panel merit review             |

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1. Sign up [here](#)
2. Ask TA for advisor letter
3. Request an Explore ACCESS Project
4. Fill the details diligently
- 5.
- 6.
- 7.
- 8.

Fill the details diligently; Public overview matters a lot, focus on it

## Explore ACCESS

**Request Information**

**Project Title \***  
Enter the title of your project here

**Public overview \***  
Your overview should touch on your project's goals, how you plan to use ACCESS resources, and any software packages you need. Covering these topics helps us ensure you get connected with appropriate resources for your work.  
Enter a public overview of your project here

**Keywords (separated by commas) \***  
Enter keywords separated by commas like astronomy, stars

**How do you plan to use this project? \***  
☐ Campus Champions  
☐ Dissertation or Thesis  
☐ Classroom / Training  
☐ Science Gateway Operation or Development  
☒ Research (non-dissertation)  
☐ Other

Your answer to this question helps ACCESS and the resource providers better prepare to support your project. For example, a classroom request will come with a syllabus, and likely later involve setting up a number of student accounts. For a **Science Gateway** project, you will likely want to establish a community user account. **Campus Champions** and other campus research computing facilitators will also probably want to establish community user accounts. Your answer here helps us serve you better, and does not otherwise affect how your request will be considered.

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# Apply for the Explore ACCESS Grant

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4. Fill the details diligently
5. Pick the following fields
- 6.
- 7.

## Pick the following fields

### Opportunity Questions

Is the planned work associated with any of the following types of activities? Check all that apply. This information is used for tracking and informational purposes and does not affect the merit of your request in any way.

☐ Rapid response

☒ Machine learning

☐ Software development

How did you hear about ACCESS?

Word of mouth (peer or colleague)

### Fields of Science

Select your project's primary field of science from the list. You may also add secondary fields of science to more fully describe your project.

☒ Primary Artificial Intelligence and Intelligent Syst... REMOVE

ADD ANOTHER FIELD OF SCIENCE

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5. Pick the following fields
6. Add teammates
- 7.

Add teammates: get them to sign up too and add them

**Related Personnel**

**SELECTED PERSONNEL AND ROLES**

| Last Name | First Name | Organization               | Request Roles |
|-----------|------------|----------------------------|---------------|
| Jain      | Shrey      | Carnegie Mellon University | PI            |

REMOVE

**ADD PERSONNEL**

To add personnel, search for a person by login or name, then choose one more roles and click "Add Person". **Exactly one person must be designated as the principal investigator (project lead).** Co-PIs and Allocation Managers, if any, will have authority to make future requests on behalf of the project. Any added persons will be listed below the search field.

**Person**

Find people by ACCESS ID, last name, or first name, e.g., "j smith"

**Role**

CoPI

Allocation Manager

ADD PERSON

Note: PI should be graduate-level and based in Pittsburgh

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5. Pick the following fields
6. Add teammates
7. Add PI Resumes
- 8.

## Add PI Resumes: Add CV for PI and CoPIs (incl. Research projects)

### Supporting Grants

Use these fields to add a supporting grant. You may add more than one.

This data is being collected according to NSF policy. Researchers are allowed only one project without a supporting NSF grant. However, when applying for multiple projects, researchers must have supporting NSF grants for each project. For more information, see the [Allocations Policy](#).

Does this request include supporting grants?

☐ Yes

☒ No

### Documents

To add a document, identify the type and click "Browse" (**PDFs only**). You may add more than one.

Type \*

-- Select One --

Title (optional)

Enter document title here

Document (PDF only) \*

Choose File No file chosen

REMOVE

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5. Pick the following fields
6. Add teammates
7. Add PI Resumes
8. Select ACCESS Credits

## Select ACCESS Credits

Available Resources

To request a resource, select it and enter an amount. Comments are optional.

[Exchange Calculator](#)

☒ ACCESS Credits

The ACCESS Credits available for Explore, Discover, and Accelerate ACCESS requests are shown on [this page](#). You will be awarded half that amount initially.

Once you've had a chance to begin working and better understand your project's needs, you can provide a brief progress report to receive the other half — or you can also apply to another allocation level if your project will need more resources.

☐ MATCHPlus

☐ Science Gateways Center of Excellence (SGX3)

SUBMIT

SAVE TO DATE

RESET FORM



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# Managing the Grant: Use Credits to get GPU Hours and Storage

## My Projects

REQUEST NEW PROJECT ▾

GET HELP ▾

▼ GrantNumber: Your Project Title

Active

Explore: Mar 5, 2025 to Mar 4, 2026 ▾

Overview

Credits + Resources

Users + Roles

History


**200,000** ACCESS Credits available



Exchange credits for resources! >





Once grant is given, dashboard shows 200k Credits.  
Use these to get both **Storage** and **GPU Hours**.

GPU Hours needed = NumProjects \* Ablations \* NumEpochs \* EpochTime

Quick estimate: 200K credits roughly equal to 3700 GPU Hours;  
10K credits roughly equal to 1TB storage

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# Managing the Grant: Use Credits to get GPU Hours and Storage

PI / CoPI manage the credits, use it to get GPU and storage  
Add **PSC Ocean** and **PSC Bridges-2 GPU**

 **30,639 ACCESS Credits available to exchange** [REQUEST MORE CREDITS](#)

| Resource                                                                                                                                                                            | Status | Unit      | Usage                                                                                | Balance  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  PSC Bridges-2 GPU  | Active | GPU Hours | 52  | 3,000                                                                                       |
|  PSC Ocean          | Active | GB        | 2   | 500                                                                                         |

Update your balance  
(can start with 1000+500)

Add another resource to your exchange...

Add resources

Need help choosing a resource? Visit our [Resource Catalog](#).

Please briefly explain how the requested resources and amounts will contribute to your research. \*

Enter your intended use here (1-2 lines)

1-2 lines explaining your use case

RESET FORM

SUBMIT FOR APPROVAL 

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